

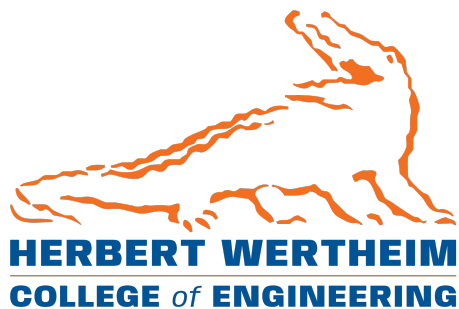
M3: Alpha Build

EEL4908 CpE Design 2

Hardened RISC-V Exam Computer

September 9, 2026

Cannon Spencer George Rushevich Justin Reyes Gabriel Velazquez



1 Alpha objective

The alpha goal is **Safe Exam Browser running on the Debian board**: a student-facing locked browser on the RISC-V hardware.

Repository: <https://github.com/cannon-spencer/riscv-exam-computer>

CI in `reptilian-riscv` builds the Debian image. Scripts here flash that image and install on-device software (`flash-os.sh`, `install-software.sh`). A board can boot Debian, join the network, and run `seb-agent`, which POSTs a heartbeat to a listener.

2 Vertical features

Element	Alpha
External interface	Debian session on the Orange Pi RV (login, network). SEB is the locked student browser on that session.
Persistent state	Flashed OS image; <code>seb-agent</code> env (<code>CONTROL_URL</code>) written by the install script.
Internal systems	CI Debian build; <code>flash-os.sh</code> and <code>install-software.sh</code> ; <code>seb-agent</code> heartbeat.

Table 1: Vertical features in the alpha build.

3 Specification mapping

Criterion	Alpha
Usability	Dedicated Debian board: power on, log in, network. SEB is the exam control surface on that session.
Interface	Debian desktop; <code>seb-agent</code> heartbeat over HTTP; image and agent env as persistent state.
Navigation	Repeatable path: flash, boot, UART or SSH, Wi-Fi via <code>nmtui</code> . Scripts wrap flash and software install.
Perception	Login and desktop on HDMI; serial/SSH output; <code>seb-agent</code> logs each heartbeat.
Responsiveness	<code>seb-agent</code> yields between POSTs (<code>sleep 5s</code>) rather than busy-waiting on I/O.
Robustness	CI image, flash, and boot complete under normal lab use (UART, SSH, outbound IP).
Consistency	The same published image and scripts produce a booting Debian board and a heartbeat POST.
Aesthetic rigor	Debian session is the on-device surface; SEB supplies the exam chrome.

Table 2: M3 specification mapping.

4 Work completed

- CI-built Debian image for the Orange Pi RV; `flash-os.sh` writes it to SD.
- Board boots, UART, Wi-Fi, SSH, outbound IP.
- `install-software.sh` deploys `seb-agent`. A heartbeat POST reaches a LAN listener.
- `seb-linux` is in-tree as a submodule. Prior compile issues on riscv64 (WebKitGTK path) still have to be cleared on this image so SEB can launch.

5 Known bugs and limitations

SEB is not yet auto-installed or launched on the image. Agent start/stop and config, instructor UI, Canvas exam flow, and kernel hardening are later work.

ID	Description	Status
BUG-01	Qt6 <code>signals</code> vs. GLib/GTK <code>signals</code> in the <code>seb-linux</code> WebKit-GTK backend.	Reported upstream; verify on this image
BUG-02	Spell-check language pointer type in <code>webkitgtk_profile.cpp</code> .	Reported upstream; verify on this image
BLK-02	No riscv64 Qt6 WebEngine; WebKitGTK fallback is the board browser path.	Constraint

Table 3: Known bugs.